



Venus Labs - PendlePTVaultAdapter

Preliminary Comments

CertiK Assessed on Mar 10th, 2026





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Venus Labs - PendlePTVaultAdapter

These preliminary comments were prepared by Certik.

Executive Summary

TYPES

Lending

ECOSYSTEM

Binance Smart Chain
(BSC)

METHODS

Manual Review, Static Analysis

LANGUAGE

Solidity

TIMELINE

Preliminary comments published on 03/05/2026

Vulnerability Summary



7

Total Findings

5

Resolved

0

Partially Resolved

2

Acknowledged

0

Declined

0

Pending

2 Centralization

2 Acknowledged

Centralization findings highlight privileged roles & functions and their capabilities, or instances where the project takes custody of users' assets.

0 Critical

Critical risks are those that impact the safe functioning of a platform and must be addressed before launch. Users should not invest in any project with outstanding critical risks.

0 Major

Major risks may include logical errors that, under specific circumstances, could result in fund losses or loss of project control.

0 Medium

Medium risks may not pose a direct risk to users' funds, but they can affect the overall functioning of a platform.

2 Minor

2 Resolved

Minor risks can be any of the above, but on a smaller scale. They generally do not compromise the overall integrity of the project, but they may be less efficient than other solutions.

3 Informational

3 Resolved

Informational errors are often recommendations to improve the style of the code or certain operations to fall within industry best practices. They usually do not affect the overall functioning of the code.

0 Discussion

The impact of the issue is yet to be determined, hence requires further clarifications from the project team.

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Disclaimer

CODEBASE | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

Repository

<https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/tree/8089a851e31b5ca16d1d2d0f02fd362c2753799a/contracts/pendle-pt-fixed-rate-vault>

<https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/tree/6be9a24be8bfb23bdfbfedbb83484a7d9872e9ca/contracts/pendle-pt-fixed-rate-vault>

Commit

[8089a851e31b5ca16d1d2d0f02fd362c2753799a](https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/tree/8089a851e31b5ca16d1d2d0f02fd362c2753799a)

[6be9a24be8bfb23bdfbfedbb83484a7d9872e9ca](https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/tree/6be9a24be8bfb23bdfbfedbb83484a7d9872e9ca)

AUDIT SCOPE | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

VenusProtocol/venus-periphery

-  PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol
-  interfaces/IPendlePTVaultAdapter.sol
-  interfaces/IVenusComptroller.sol
-  interfaces/IVenusVToken.sol

APPROACH & METHODS

VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

This audit was conducted for Venus to evaluate the security and correctness of the smart contracts associated with the Venus Labs - PendlePTVaultAdapter project. The assessment included a comprehensive review of the in-scope smart contracts. The audit was performed using a combination of Manual Review and Static Analysis.

The review process emphasized the following areas:

- Architecture review and threat modeling to understand systemic risks and identify design-level flaws.
- Identification of vulnerabilities through both common and edge-case attack vectors.
- Manual verification of contract logic to ensure alignment with intended design and business requirements.
- Dynamic testing to validate runtime behavior and assess execution risks.
- Assessment of code quality and maintainability, including adherence to current best practices and industry standards.

The audit resulted in findings categorized across multiple severity levels, from informational to critical. To enhance the project's security and long-term robustness, we recommend addressing the identified issues and considering the following general improvements:

- Improve code readability and maintainability by adopting a clean architectural pattern and modular design.
- Strengthen testing coverage, including unit and integration tests for key functionalities and edge cases.
- Maintain meaningful inline comments and documentations.
- Implement clear and transparent documentation for privileged roles and sensitive protocol operations.
- Regularly review and simulate contract behavior against newly emerging attack vectors.

OVERVIEW | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

This audit concerns the changes made in the in scope files outlined in the following PR:

- [PR-53](#)

Note that any centralization risks present in the existing codebase before these PRs were not considered in this audit and only those added in these PRs are addressed in the audit. We recommend all users carefully review the centralization risks, much of which can be found in our previous audits, which can be found here: <https://skynet.certik.com/projects/venus>.

PR-53

This PR introduces the **PendlePTVaultAdapter**, an upgradeable adapter that unifies Pendle PT conversion and Venus vault interactions into single transactions, enabling users to move seamlessly between tokens (or native BNB) and Venus vToken positions backed by Pendle PT. The contract supports `deposit()` and `depositNative()` flows that swap input assets to PT through the Pendle router and mint vToken on behalf of the user. In addition it includes `withdraw()` (pre-maturity) and `redeemAtMaturity()` (post-maturity) flows that redeem vToken back to PT and then either swap PT to a target token or redeem PT at maturity.

DEPENDENCIES | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

Third Party Dependencies

The protocol is serving as the underlying entity to interact with third party protocols. The third parties that the contracts interact with are:

- ERC20 Tokens
- Pendle
- Oracles

The scope of the audit treats third party entities as black boxes and assumes their functional correctness. However, in the real world, third parties can be compromised and this may lead to lost or stolen assets. Moreover, updates to the state of a project contract that are dependent on the read of the state of external third party contracts may make the project vulnerable to read-only reentrancy. In addition, upgrades of third parties can possibly create severe impacts, such as increasing fees of third parties, migrating to new LP pools, etc.

Recommendations

We recommend constantly monitoring the third parties involved to mitigate any side effects that may occur when unexpected changes are introduced, as well as vetting any third party contracts used to ensure no external calls can be made before updates to its state.

FINDINGS | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER



7

Total Findings

0

Critical

2

Centralization

0

Major

0

Medium

2

Minor

3

Informational

0

Discussion

This report has been prepared for Venus to identify potential vulnerabilities and security issues within the reviewed codebase. During the course of the audit, a total of 7 issues were identified. Leveraging a combination of Manual Review & Static Analysis the following findings were uncovered:

ID	Title	Category	Severity	Status
VLP-05	Centralization Risks In PendlePTVaultAdapter.Sol	Centralization	Centralization	● Acknowledged
VLP-06	Centralized Control Of Contract Upgrade	Centralization	Centralization	● Acknowledged
VLP-01	<code>depositNative()</code> Emits Incorrect <code>tokenIn</code> In Event	Inconsistency	Minor	● Resolved
VLP-07	Missing Input Validations	Logical Issue	Minor	● Resolved
VLP-02	Dust Amount Deposited Can Mint 0 VToken	Logical Issue	Informational	● Resolved
VLP-08	Use Of <code>reinitializer(1)</code> Instead Of <code>initializer</code>	Inconsistency	Informational	● Resolved
VLP-09	Missing Emit Events	Coding Style	Informational	● Resolved

VLP-05 | Centralization Risks In PendlePTVaultAdapter.Sol

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Centralization	Centralization	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 295, 327, 333, 338, 345	Acknowledged

Description

In the contract `PendlePTVaultAdapter`, the role `DEFAULT_ADMIN_ROLE` of the `AccessControlManager` can grant addresses the privilege to call the following functions:

- `addMarket()`
- `pause()`
- `unpause()`

Any compromise to the `DEFAULT_ADMIN_ROLE` or accounts granted this privilege may allow the hacker to take advantage of this authority and do the following:

- Halt all user entry/exit flows guarded by `whenNotPaused`.
- Re-enable operations at arbitrary times (`unpause`), reducing operator trust assumptions.
- Register additional markets that satisfy on-chain checks but may still be economically unsafe (e.g., poor liquidity / adverse execution conditions), exposing delegating users to governance-selected market risk.

In the contract `PendlePTVaultAdapter`, the role `_owner` has authority over the following functions:

- `sweepTokens()`
- `sweepNative()`

Any compromise to the `_owner` may allow the hacker to take advantage of this authority and do the following:

- Transfer out any ERC-20 or native BNB currently held by the adapter (including accidental transfers and residual balances).
- Capture funds that were expected to remain recoverable by users through normal adapter dust/refund behavior.

Recommendation

The risk describes the current project design and potentially makes iterations to improve in the security operation and level of decentralization, which in most cases cannot be resolved entirely at the present stage. We advise the client to carefully manage the privileged account's private key to avoid any potential risks of being hacked. In general, we strongly recommend centralized privileges or roles in the protocol be improved via a decentralized mechanism or smart-contract-based accounts with enhanced security practices, e.g., multisignature wallets. Indicatively, here are some feasible suggestions that would also mitigate the potential risk at a different level in terms of short-term, long-term and permanent:

Short Term:

Timelock and Multi sign (2%, 3%) combination *mitigate* by delaying the sensitive operation and avoiding a single point of key management failure.

- Time-lock with reasonable latency, e.g., 48 hours, for awareness on privileged operations;
AND
- Assignment of privileged roles to multi-signature wallets to prevent a single point of failure due to the private key compromised;
AND
- A medium/blog link for sharing the timelock contract and multi-signers addresses information with the public audience.

Long Term:

Timelock and DAO, the combination, *mitigate* by applying decentralization and transparency.

- Time-lock with reasonable latency, e.g., 48 hours, for awareness on privileged operations;
AND
- Introduction of a DAO/governance/voting module to increase transparency and user involvement.
AND
- A medium/blog link for sharing the timelock contract, multi-signers addresses, and DAO information with the public audience.

Permanent:

Renouncing the ownership or removing the function can be considered *fully resolved*.

- Renounce the ownership and never claim back the privileged roles.
OR
- Remove the risky functionality.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The ownership of all contracts will be transferred to the standard Venus Normal Timelock. ACM permissions will be assigned to specific timelocks based on the required level of control, normal, fast-track, or critical, and a guardian will be designated for critical setters. All permission assignments will be executed through a VIP and approved via Venus governance, accompanied by a community post to ensure transparency to users.

VLP-06 | Centralized Control Of Contract Upgrade

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Centralization	● Centralization	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 33	● Acknowledged

Description

The proxy admin has the authority to update the implementation contract `PendlePTVaultAdapter`.

Any compromise to the proxy admin account may allow a hacker to take advantage of this authority and change the implementation contract which is pointed by proxy and therefore execute potential malicious functionality in the implementation contract.

Recommendation

We recommend that the team make efforts to restrict access to the admin of the proxy contract. A strategy of combining a time-lock and a multi-signature (2/3, 3/5) wallet can be used to prevent a single point of failure due to a private key compromise. In addition, the team should be transparent and notify the community in advance whenever they plan to migrate to a new implementation contract.

Here are some feasible short-term and long-term suggestions that would mitigate the potential risk to a different level and suggestions that would permanently fully resolve the risk.

Short Term:

A combination of a time-lock and a multi signature (2/3, 3/5) wallet mitigate the risk by delaying the sensitive operation and avoiding a single point of key management failure.

- A time-lock with reasonable latency, such as 48 hours, for awareness of privileged operations;
AND
- Assignment of privileged roles to multi-signature wallets to prevent a single point of failure due to a private key compromised;
AND
- A medium/blog link for sharing the time-lock contract and multi-signers addresses information with the community.

For remediation and mitigated status, please provide the following information:

- Provide the deployed time-lock address.
- Provide the **gnosis** address with **ALL** the multi-signer addresses for the verification process.
- Provide a link to the **medium/blog** with all of the above information included.

Long Term:

A combination of a time-lock on the contract upgrade operation and a DAO for controlling the upgrade operation mitigate the contract upgrade risk by applying transparency and decentralization.

- A time-lock with reasonable latency, such as 48 hours, for community awareness of privileged operations;
AND
- Introduction of a DAO, governance, or voting module to increase decentralization, transparency, and user involvement;
AND
- A medium/blog link for sharing the time-lock contract, multi-signers addresses, and DAO information with the community.

For remediation and mitigated status, please provide the following information:

- Provide the deployed time-lock address.
- Provide the **gnosis** address with **ALL** the multi-signer addresses for the verification process.
- Provide a link to the **medium/blog** with all of the above information included.

Permanent:

Renouncing ownership of the `admin` account or removing the upgrade functionality can *fully* resolve the risk.

- Renounce the ownership and never claim back the privileged role;
OR
- Remove the risky functionality.

Note: we recommend the project team consider the long-term solution or the permanent solution. The project team shall make a decision based on the current state of their project, timeline, and project resources.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The admin of the contracts on BNB Chain (where these contracts will be deployed) will be the ProxyAdmin contract at 0x1BB765b741A5f3C2A338369DAb539385534E3343. The owner of this ProxyAdmin is the Normal Timelock contract at 0x939bD8d64c0A9583A7Dcea9933f7b21697ab6396, which is responsible for executing standard Venus Improvement Proposals (VIPs) on BNB Chain. For normal VIPs, the governance process includes: 24 hours of voting, 48 hours of timelock delay before execution. Therefore, any upgrade to these contracts can only be executed through a Normal VIP, ensuring that changes go through the Venus community governance process.

VLP-01 | `depositNative()` Emits Incorrect `tokenIn` In Event

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Inconsistency	Minor	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 212	Resolved

Description

The `depositNative()` function emits the `input.tokenIn` parameter in the `Deposited` event without validation. This parameter is user-provided and may not represent the actual native token (BNB) used in the transaction.

In the function:

```
emit Deposited(pendleMarket, msg.sender, input.tokenIn, msg.value, netPtOut, netVTokensMinted);
```

The `input.tokenIn` value comes from the `TokenInput` calldata parameter and could be any address, potentially misleading off-chain monitoring systems about which token was actually deposited. For native BNB deposits, the token address should be explicitly set to `address(0)` or a known native token wrapper address.

Scenario

1. Call `depositNative()` with `input.tokenIn` set to an arbitrary ERC20 token address
2. Observe the emitted `Deposited` event shows the arbitrary address as the deposited token
3. Off-chain systems may incorrectly interpret this as an ERC20 deposit rather than a native BNB deposit

Recommendation

Replace `input.tokenIn` with `address(0)` in the `Deposited` event emission within `depositNative()` to accurately reflect that native BNB was deposited. Enforce `input.tokenIn` is actually `address(0)`.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The team heeded the advice and resolved the issue in <https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/pull/55/changes/ada7f3fe00a32d46c5eb447afb9504a2c152cd2a>

VLP-07 | Missing Input Validations

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Logical Issue	Minor	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 132, 173, 177	Resolved

Description

In the function `depositNative()`, it does not check that the `input.tokenIn` is the Pendle's native token placeholder.

The functions `deposit()` and `depositNative()` do not check that it is before maturity. While `swapExactTokenForPt()` will revert if it is at or after maturity, it is still recommended to add the check for clearer local erroring.

The function `deposit()`, does not check that `msg.value == 0`.

Recommendation

We recommend adding the input validations mentioned above.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: `deposit()` and `depositNative()` check that it is before maturity: we chose not to add an explicit `beforeMaturity` check. Pendle Router's `swapExactTokenForPt()` already reverts at or after maturity, making the local check redundant.

VLP-02 | Dust Amount Deposited Can Mint 0 VToken

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Logical Issue	● Informational	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 458	● Resolved

Description

The `mintBehalf()` function calculates the amount of vToken to mint by dividing the supplied `ptAmount` by the current exchange rate. When the input amount is less than the exchange rate, the division rounds down to zero, resulting in no vToken being minted. The contract does not perform a check or revert in this situation, so the user's deposited amount is accepted but not credited with any vToken, effectively forfeiting this dust amount to the protocol.

Recommendation

We recommend ensuring users are aware of this and do not supply dust amounts, or alternatively, add a check to ensure they are minted at least 1 vToken.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The team heeded the advice and resolved the issue in <http://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/pull/55/changes/cc89c8687e877c4e7d0b2aff8a9cd72d92c59ab1>

VLP-08 | Use Of `reinitializer(1)` Instead Of `initializer`

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Inconsistency	● Informational	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 118	● Resolved

Description

The contract's first initialization function uses the `reinitializer(1)` modifier. For initial proxy setup, `initializer` is the consistently used modifier.

Recommendation

We recommend using `initializer` for consistency.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The team heeded the advice and resolved the issue in <https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/pull/55/changes/cc6002b4440f930e3b6ddd49b5dc1dd22c80dce5>

VLP-09 | Missing Emit Events

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Coding Style	● Informational	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 338, 345	● Resolved

Description

There should always be events emitted in sensitive functions that are controlled by centralization roles.

Recommendation

We recommend emitting events in sensitive functions that are controlled by centralization roles.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The team heeded the advice and resolved the issue in <https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/pull/55/changes/36a4279401b2c634adce74d1df665ea733a3df8d>

OPTIMIZATIONS | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

ID	Title	Category	Severity	Status
VLP-03	Redundant Getters	Gas Optimization	Optimization	Resolved

VLP-03 | Redundant Getters

Category	Severity	Location	Status
Gas Optimization	● Optimization	PendlePTVaultAdapter.sol (Base): 355~357	● Resolved

Description

The linked functions are equivalent to the compiler-generated getter functions for the respective variables.

Recommendation

We recommend removing the redundant getters.

Alleviation

[Venus, 03/10/2026]: The team heeded the advice and resolved the issue in <https://github.com/VenusProtocol/venus-periphery/pull/55/changes/da58e96f7c070d200d36859dcf9b11a0d2515253>

APPENDIX | VENUS LABS - PENDLEPTVAULTADAPTER

Finding Categories

Categories	Description
Gas Optimization	Gas Optimization findings do not affect the functionality of the code but generate different, more optimal EVM opcodes resulting in a reduction on the total gas cost of a transaction.
Coding Style	Coding Style findings may not affect code behavior, but indicate areas where coding practices can be improved to make the code more understandable and maintainable.
Inconsistency	Inconsistency findings refer to different parts of code that are not consistent or code that does not behave according to its specification.
Logical Issue	Logical Issue findings indicate general implementation issues related to the program logic.
Centralization	Centralization findings detail the design choices of designating privileged roles or other centralized controls over the code.

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